

Human Override Module (HOM)

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Canonical Definition

Human Override Module (HOM) defines the structural conditions under which authorized human operators may intervene, override, suspend, or terminate autonomous operation while preserving governance legitimacy, operational safety, and accountability.

HOM governs human override.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that human intervention remains authorized, controlled, traceable, and governance-approved throughout autonomous operation.

Autonomy enables independent operation.

Governance preserves the ability for responsible human intervention.

HOM governs that intervention.

Module Operational Role

HOM defines the human override layer of AESS.

Its role is to ensure that authorized human operators can safely assume operational control whenever autonomous operation must no longer continue independently.

Module Operational Space

HOM governs:

- human override,
- human operational intervention,
- manual operational control,
- autonomous operation suspension,
- governed human intervention,
- operational control transfer,
- emergency human override,
- override governance.

Module Function

The module applies wherever organizations require authorized human operators to intervene in autonomous operations under predefined governance conditions.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Human Override Object Identify which autonomous operations permit or require human override.

2. Define Override Conditions

Establish governance conditions governing when and how authorized human intervention may occur.

3. Define Override Failure Logic

Identify conditions where human override is unavailable, delayed, unauthorized, ineffective, or governance-invalid.

4. Define Governance Response

Define governance actions for operational takeover, execution suspension, emergency intervention, authority transfer, or controlled recovery.

5. Preserve Override Traceability

Preserve override requests, governance approvals, operational evidence, intervention history, and supporting documentation.

Use Case 1 — Autonomous Passenger Aircraft

Scenario

An autonomous flight management system encounters rapidly changing weather conditions beyond predefined operational limits.

Application

HOM enables the authorized pilot to immediately assume operational control.

Result

Operational safety is preserved through governed human intervention.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous Surgical Robot

Scenario

An autonomous surgical assistant detects unexpected complications during a medical procedure.

Application

HOM transfers operational control to the supervising surgeon through governance-approved override procedures.

Result

The procedure continues under direct human authority while preserving patient safety and operational accountability.

Canonical Closing Statement

Responsible autonomy requires responsible human intervention. Human Override ensures that authorized operators can assume operational control whenever governance, safety, or operational legitimacy requires autonomous operation to yield to human judgment.

Related Documents

→ [Autonomous Escalation Standard \(AESS\)](#)

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Canonical Source

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